

Across Borders: Pressure Builds

跨越边界：压力上升

Theme: 旅行、交通与文化交流 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The pressure built **after** a **lengthy morning** in court. The council had moved the hearing twice, and the **township** had offered one more **decade** of patience and no more money. May and June had gone; maybe the offer would come in September, and perhaps it would not come at all. Since the **outset**, the team had promised one thing: they would remain until the service was **efficient** or until it was clear that it could not be.

A **pessimistic** councillor supposed that the whole exercise was a **pastime** for students. “I **refuse** to **praise** a report that refuses to name a price,” he said. “You **deserve** the **applause** you get, and no more.” The rejection was brief and **utter**, and the **applause** that followed it was for him.

The **gratitude** of the travellers was harder to dismiss. A trader in illegal **trafficking** had been confined for a month; a **hateful** landlord had raised the rent of the **inn**; a **contemptible** clause in the contract had been signed **repeatedly**. “A **worthwhile** project is one that survives its own bad **decade**,” Aisha said. “We are **presently** in it.”

They would **finally interact** with the council through a single document, and they would **maintain** one copy of it in the local language. “I **bet** they **postpone** the vote,” Lin wrote. “I **bet** they **resign** the question instead.” The **lump** in his throat was not fear; it was the **thank** you he had not said to his father, who had died that spring.

The eventual answer arrived **shortly** before the election. It was not a **marvel**, and it was not **admirable**; it was a **permission** with three conditions. “Be **thankful** for the small ones,” Maya said. “**Forever** is not our business.” The group applauded once, quietly, and went back to work on the timetable. Across the day and the court, the council moved once more, and the offer remained possible. “Maybe we go, perhaps we stay,” Lin wrote. “One thing is certain: the **permission** has been ours only since May.” They had to **maintain** the service for a **decade**, to **praise** nothing they had not seen, and to **thank** the clerk who had lost her own job to help them. A **century** of habit was harder to **reject** than a clause; **eventually** they would **pray** for a better vote, **contend** with the **popularity** of the old route, and ask whether a **confinement** of one month could ever be justified when the alternative was nothing.

中文翻译

压力在法庭上一个漫长的早晨之后不断累积。委员会两次推迟了听证，而小镇又给了十年的耐心，却没有多给一分钱。五月和六月过去了；也许报价会在九月到来，也许根本不会来。从一开始，团队就承诺了一件事：他们会留下，直到服务变得有效率，或者直到清楚它不可能有效率。

一位悲观的地方议员推测，整个做法不过是学生们的消遣。“我拒绝称赞一份拒绝给出价格的报告，”他说，“你得到多少掌声就配多少，不多不少。”拒绝简短而彻底，而随后的掌声是给他的。

旅客们的感激更难被推开。一位从事非法交易的商人被关了两个月；一位可恨的房东提高了客栈的租金；合同里一条可鄙的条款被反复签署。“值得做的项目，是能挺过自己糟糕的十年的项目，”艾莎说，“而我们目前正在十年里。”

他们最终会通过一份文件与委员会互动，并会保留一份用当地语言写成的副本。“我打赌他们会推迟表决，”林伟写道，“我打赌他们会把问题搁置。”他喉咙里那个肿块不是恐惧；那是他没能对父亲说出口的那句谢谢——父亲在那年春天去世了。

最终的答复在选举前不久到来。它不是奇迹，也不值得钦佩；它是一份带三个条件的许可。“要为这些小东西感到感激，”曼雅说，“永远不是我们的事。”小组轻轻鼓了一次掌，然后回去继续做时刻表。日子一天天过去，法庭那边，议会又一次行动，而那份报价也仍然有可能。“我们也许走，也许留，”林伟写道，“有一件事是确定的：这份许可从五月起才属于我们。”他们必须把这项服务维持十年，必须不称赞任何他们没见过的东西，必须感谢那位为了帮他们而丢了自己工作的职员。一个世纪的习惯，比一条条款更难拒绝；最终他们会为一次更好的表决而祈祷，会去应付旧路线的受欢迎程度，也会问：当替代方案是什么都没有时，一个月的封闭是否真的能被证明正当。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
after 'ɑ:ftə POS: prep	prep. 在...之后, 由于; conj. 在...之后; adv. 后来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. located farther aft; r. behind or in the rear
morning 'mɔ:nɪŋ POS: n	n. 早晨, 早上, 初期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time period between dawn and noon
century 'sentʃʊri POS: n	n. 世纪, 百年 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a period of 100 years
finally 'faɪnəli POS: adv	adv. 最后, 终于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. after an unspecified period of time or an especially long delay
thank θæŋk POS: n	n. 谢意, 感谢; vt. 谢谢, 感谢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. express gratitude or show appreciation to
decade 'dekeɪd POS: n	n. 十年, 十 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a period of 10 years
maintain meɪn'teɪn POS: vt	vt. 维持, 维修, 保持, 坚持, 供养, 主张; [化] 维修 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. state or assert
suppose sə'pəʊz POS: vt	vt. 推想, 假设, 以为, 想像, 假定; vi. 料想 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. express a supposition
refuse rɪ'fju:z POS: vt	vt. 拒绝, 谢绝; vi. 拒绝; n. 废物; a. 扔掉的, 无用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. show unwillingness towards; v. refuse to accept
eventually ɪ'ventʃʊəli POS: adv	adv. 最后, 终于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r after an unspecified period of time or an especially long delay
reject rɪ'dʒekt POS: n	n. 被拒之人, 被弃之物, 不合格品, 次品; vt. 拒绝, 抵制, 否决, 驳回, 丢弃, 呕出 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. refuse to accept or acknowledge; v. reject with contempt; v. refuse entrance or membership
forever fə'revə POS: adv	adv. 永远 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. for a very long or seemingly endless time
efficient ɪ'fɪjənt POS: a	a. 有效率的, 能干的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. being effective without wasting time or effort or expense
deserve dɪ'zə:v POS: vt	vt. 该得到, 值得; vi. 应得报答 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be worthy or deserving
shortly 'ʃɔ:tli POS: adv	adv. 不久, 简短, 唐突地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. for a short time; r. at a short distance
pray preɪ POS: v	v. 祈祷, 恳求, 请 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. address a deity, a prophet, a saint or an object of worship; say a prayer
permission pə'mɪʃən POS: n	n. 许可, 允许; [计] 许可, 认可 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. approval to do something
resign rɪ'zain POS: vt	vt. 辞职, 放弃, 使顺从; vi. 辞职, 屈从 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. accept as inevitable
bet bet POS: n	n. 打赌, 赌注; v. 打赌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of gambling; v. maintain with or as if with a bet; v. stake on the outcome of an issue
repeatedly rɪ'pi:tɪdli POS: adv	adv. 重复地, 再三地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. several time
contend kən'tend POS: vi	vi. 奋斗, 斗争, 竞争; vt. 为...斗争 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. maintain or assert; v. be engaged in a fight; carry on a fight
praise preɪz POS: n	n. 赞美, 称赞, 崇拜; vt. 称赞, 赞美; vi. 赞扬, 表扬 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an expression of approval and commendation; n. offering words of homage as an act of worship; v. express app...
inn ɪn POS: n	n. 旅馆, 客栈; vi. 住旅馆 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a hotel providing overnight lodging for travelers
popularity ,ppjʊ'lærɪti POS: n	n. 名声, 受大众欢迎, 流行 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the quality of being widely admired or accepted or sought after

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
worthwhile 'wɜ:θ'haɪl POS: a	a. 值得花时间的, 值得做的, 有真实价值的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. sufficiently valuable to justify the investment of time or interest
lump lʌmp POS: n	n. 块, 瘤, 很多, 肿块, 笨人; vt. 使成块状, 混在一起; vi. 结块 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. put together indiscriminately
interact ,ɪntər'ækt POS: vi	vi. 互相影响, 交互作用; n. 幕间剧, 幕间休息 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. act together or towards others or with others
lengthy 'lenʒi POS: a	a. 冗长的, 漫长的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. relatively long in duration; tediously protracted
postpone pəʊst'pəʊn POS: vt	vt. 延迟, 使延期, 缓办, 搁延; vi. 延缓, 延缓发作 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. hold back to a later time
applause ə'plɔ:z POS: n	n. 鼓掌, 喝彩, 赞许 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a demonstration of approval by clapping the hands together
presently 'prezntli POS: adv	adv. 目前, 不久 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. at this time or period; now
outset 'aʊtset POS: n	n. 着手, 开头, 最初 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the time at which something is supposed to begin
applaud ə'plɔ:d POS: v	v. 拍手喝彩, 称赞, 赞同 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. clap one's hands or shout after performances to indicate approval; v. express approval of
utter 'ʌtə POS: a	a. 全然的, 绝对的, 完全的; vt. 发出声音, 做声, 发表, 发射, 流通 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. express audibly; utter sounds (not necessarily words); v. put into circulation
gratitude 'grætiʃjʊd POS: n	n. 感激之情 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a feeling of thankfulness and appreciation
marvel 'mɑ:vl POS: n	n. 奇异事物, 罕见例子; vt. 惊异于; vi. 惊异 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. express astonishment or surprise about something
thankful 'θæŋkful POS: a	a. 感谢的, 感激的, 欣慰的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a feeling or showing gratitude
admirable 'ædmərəbl POS: a	a. 可钦佩的, 极好的, 令人惊奇的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. deserving of the highest esteem or admiration; s. inspiring admiration or approval
township 'taʊnʃɪp POS: n	n. 小镇, 镇区; [法] 镇区, 乡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an administrative division of a county
pessimistic ,pesi'mistik POS: a	a. 悲观的, 厌世的, 悲观主义的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. expecting the worst possible outcome
trafficking 'træfɪkɪŋ POS: n	n. 非法交易 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. deal illegally; v. trade or deal a commodity
confinement kən'faɪnmənt POS: n	n. 限制, 被禁闭, 分娩; [医] 分娩, 生产 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of restraining of a person's liberty by confining them; n. the state of being confined
pastime 'pæstaim POS: n	n. 消遣, 娱乐, 游戏 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a diversion that occupies one's time and thoughts (usually pleasantly)
hateful 'heitful POS: a	a. 憎恨的, 可恨的, 可恶的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. evoking or deserving hatred; s. characterized by malice
contemptible kən'temptɪbl POS: a	a. 卑鄙的, 可轻蔑的, 不足挂齿的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. deserving of contempt or scorn